

ATHLETICS: TRACK AND FIELD



Athletics refers to several competitions in running, walking, leaping, and throwing activities. It is also known as track and field sports. Even though these competitions are known as track and field (or just track) in the United States, they are typically referred to as athletics abroad. Track and field athletics, which sprang from the most fundamental human activities—running, walking, jumping, and throwing—are the oldest forms of organized sport. The most truly global sport now is athletics, with competitions taking place in almost every nation on Earth. The majority of countries send men's and women's teams to the four-yearly Olympic Games and the track and field World Championships. Several continental and international championship competitions are also staged—including the African, Asian, Commonwealth, European, and Pan-American.

There are up to 20 different events that fall under the general heading of athletics. These activities make up a Meet, which is typically held outside. The field events (jumping and throwing) occur either inside the track's confines or in nearby regions, while the outdoor running competitions occur on a 400-meter or 440-yard oval track. The sport is moved indoors during the winter in many regions, most notably in North America and Europe. Due to space restrictions, certain events are modified, and others are eliminated. Separate but similar competitions not held on the track fall under the overall umbrella of track and field athletics.

Competitions for cross-country running are held in various sorts of parkland and rural areas. Long-distance race walks are competed on measured road courses, while marathons and other long-distance races are run on roads. The International Association of Athletics Federations (IAAF) and each of its member organizations from each country set and uphold the regulations that are adhered to in all scheduled contests. All world records are ratified by the IAAF as well.

Introduction, Origin, and Development

The earliest days of athletics as an organized sport are not well documented. Many years before the Christian era, it is known that Asian and Egyptian cultures promoted athletics. Ireland hosted the Tailteann Games for the Lughnasa festival, which featured different track and field events, possibly as early as 1829 BC. Greek

Olympic competitions began in 776 BC and were held for 11 centuries before ending in 393 AD. As far as competitors and viewers were concerned, these ancient Olympics were exclusively male spectacles. According to legend, Greek women created their own Heraea Games, held every four (4) years, just like the Olympics.



England was the birthplace of modern athletics and the country where it matured. When practicing fields were first built in London in 1154, the earliest mention of the sport in England was made. King Edward III outlawed the activity in the 1300s, but Henry VIII, who was rumored to be an expert hammer thrower, brought it back in the 20th century. However, the modernization of the sport only began in the early 19th century. Although organized amateur footraces began to take place in England as early as 1825, athletics had its greatest growth up to that point in 1860.

By the late 1800s, athletics had spread throughout many nations, but it wasn't until the Olympic Games were revived in 1896 that the sport truly became global. Despite having a humble beginning, the Olympics inspired and standardized a movement that would spark interest in athletics all across the world. The International Amateur Athletic Federation (IAAF) was established in 1912 and had more than 170 country members by the time it celebrated its 75th anniversary in 1987, up until 1936, when the IAAF also took over as the sport's regulatory body for women's competition, its rules solely applied to men's competition.

Before World War II, significant international contests included the Olympics, British Empire Games, and European Championships, but following the war, athletics underwent its greatest phase of expansion, gaining hold, particularly in the developing nations. World-class athletes from Latin American, Asian, and African nations were having remarkable success at international competitions by the 1950s.

Facilities and Equipment

Certain pieces of equipment are necessary for the operation of every event. For instance, all athletes need to wear lightweight shoes that provide traction and protection. The starting blocks used by sprinters and hurdlers, hurdles, vaulting poles, and the implements used in the various throwing events are additional pieces of equipment.

Tracks with indoor playing fields are a common design element for track and field facilities. Track and field athletics sports facilities are typically utilized for everyday practice as well as hosting regional or local competitions. Higher-level events typically have more demanding standards for the sporting facilities, especially in terms of infrastructure.

Athletics fields are typically multi-use, with the 400-meter track's inner serving as a field for rugby, soccer, and gridiron. These tracks are frequently utilized for non-sporting occasions like concerts and town hall meetings. The IAAF Track and Field Facilities Manual specifies the sizes and tools required for top athletes to compete in high-level international and other competitions.

1. Football Pitch
2. Standard Track

3. Long & Triple Jump
Facility

4. Water Jump

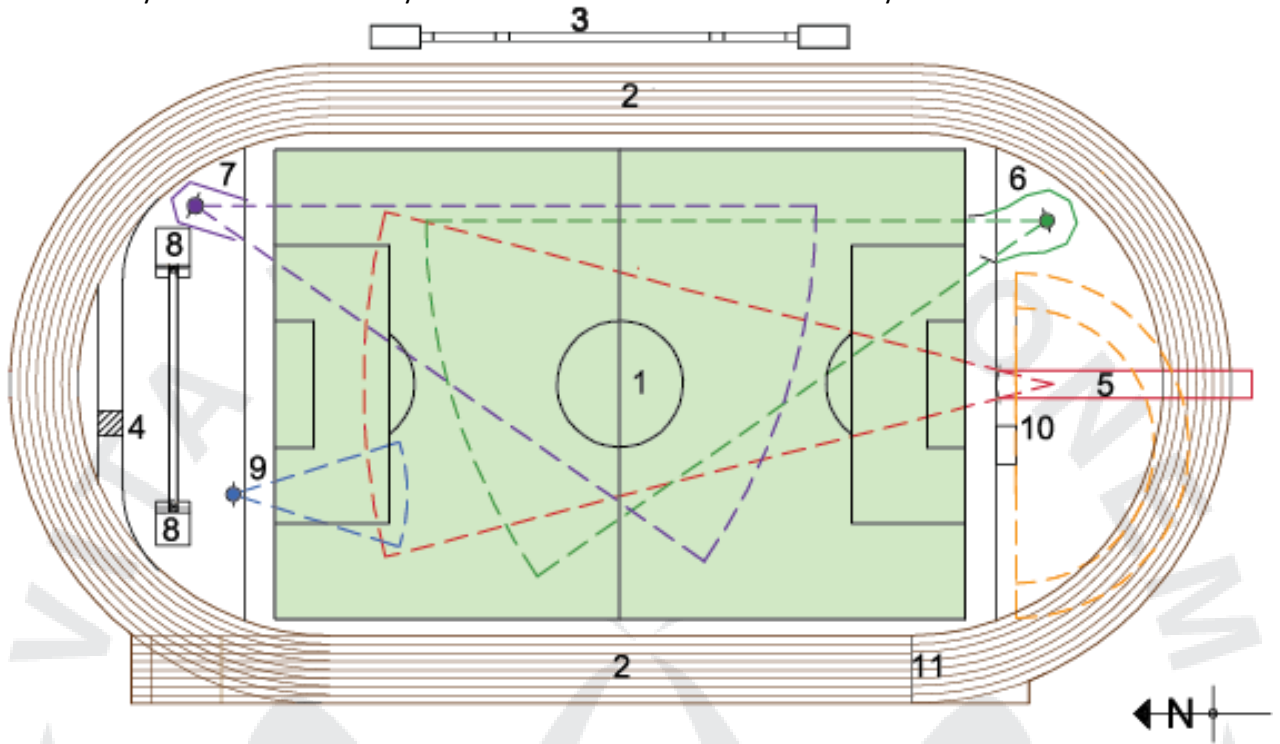
5. Javelin Throw
Facility

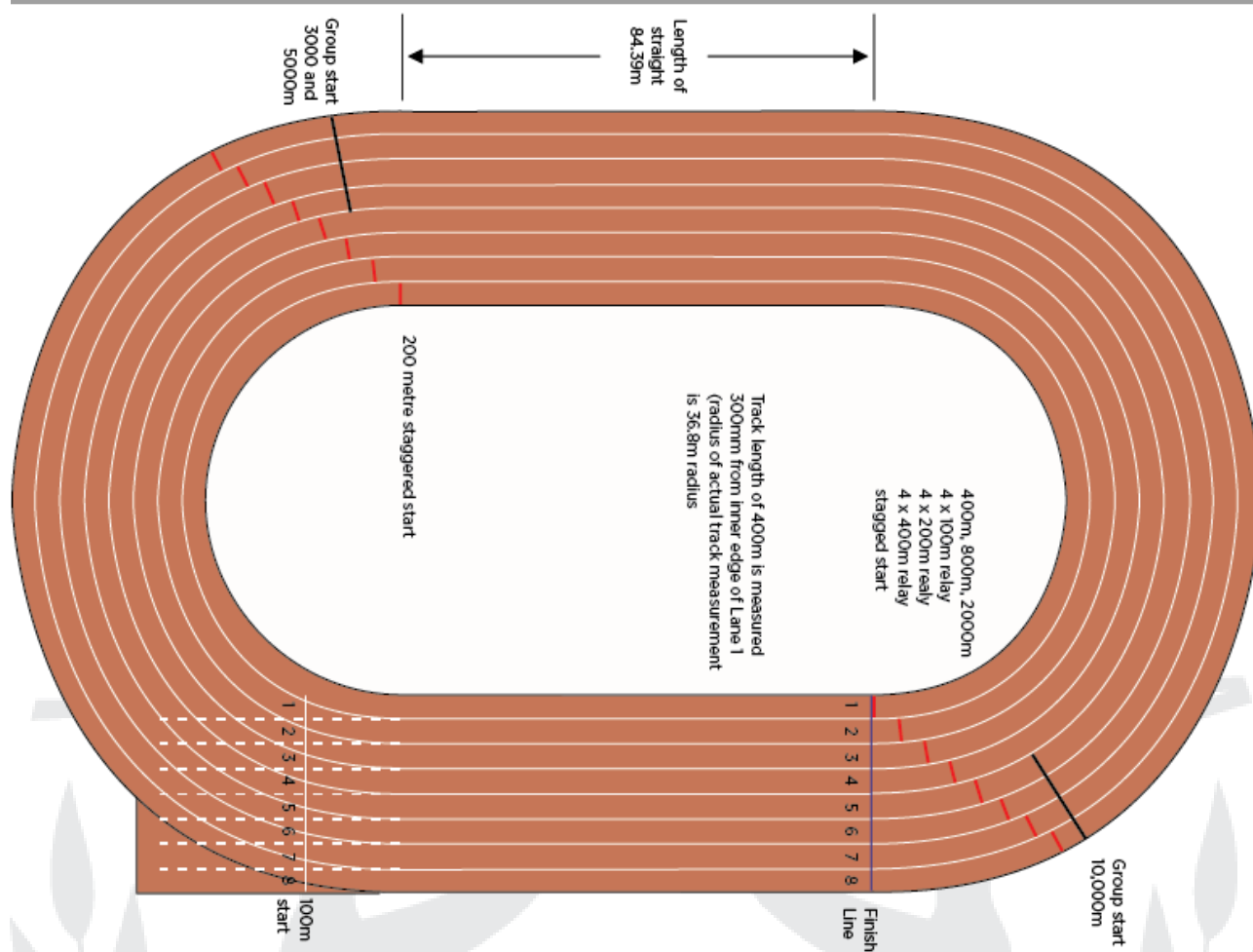
6. Discus & Hammer
Throw Facility

7. Discus Throw
Facility

8. Pole Vault Facility
9. Shot Put Facility

10. High Jump Facility
11. Finish Line





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